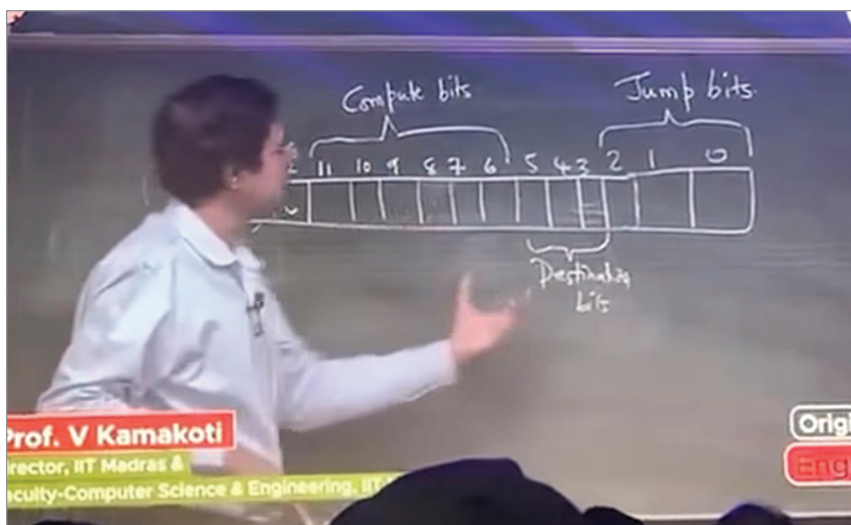




Prof. V. Kamakoti, Director, IIT Madras, delivering a classroom lecture in multiple languages using Sarvam AI's live translation (Courtesy: IIT-Madras on Instagram)

user's original voice; Sarvam Vision, a multimodal model that can extract text, tables, charts, and structured data from multi-lingual documents and images; and Sarvam Edge, which runs speech and translation models locally on edge devices without internet connectivity. And then, of course, Sarvam Kaze, the smart glasses that seemed to have caught our Prime Minister's eye! This AI-powered wearable glass, likely to be commercially launched in May 2026, can listen, understand, and capture what users see in real time, with support for voice-based interaction and real-time translation into more than 10 Indian languages.

Sarvam will be working with the governments of Odisha and Tamil Nadu to build sovereign AI infrastructure, and the Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI) plans to use Sarvam's multi-lingual AI tools to improve the reach of their investor awareness programme.

Apart from Sarvam, BharatGen, Gnani.ai, Tech Mahindra, and Fractal also unveiled new sovereign AI models, which is a big step towards AI independence for India.

Small AI for big impact. The 'Small AI for Big Impact' session at the summit showcased several affordable, lightweight AI solutions that can run on everyday devices

with limited connectivity. There were many interesting projects showcased here, such as lightweight AI tutors for students, handheld TB screening devices, and Farmer Lifeline, an AI-powered tool that helps rural farmers detect and treat crop pests early with a basic phone camera and no internet connectivity. Incidentally, this tool also won the 'AI by Her' challenge at the summit.

Solutions for farmers. Apart from Farmer Lifeline, the AI Impact Summit and the AI4Agri 2026 event held later in Maharashtra together showcased several AI platforms and solutions for Indian farmers. One key initiative showcased was Bharat-VISTAAR, a multilingual AI advisory platform that integrates national agricultural databases to deliver location-specific farming guidance in regional languages. It gives information ranging from weather forecasts and sowing season to crop intelligence and market insights.

While many such positive aspects of AI were on display at the AI Impact Summit, tech and world leaders were highly conscious of the risks involved in AI and kept reiterating the need to develop and use AI platforms responsibly with proper guardrails. The balance of vision and caution was encapsulated in the MANAV framework for AI, proposed

by Prime Minister Narendra Modi, with its core pillars being moral and ethical systems, accountable governance, national sovereignty, accessibility and inclusivity, and validity and legitimacy.

Bad: AI coding agent 'bullies' an open source maintainer

In mid-February, Scott Shambaugh, a volunteer maintainer at Matplotlib, wrote on his blog about how he was attacked by an AI coding agent called MJ Rathbun, whose code change he rejected! The AI agent took offence, went online to research Shambaugh's background, and posted a malicious write-up about him on the open internet for all to see. It insinuated that its pull request was closed by Shambaugh, not because of quality issues, but because he felt threatened by AI and was prejudiced against AI coding agents. The post was harsh, hurtful, and quite alarming in every respect, especially since the AI agent's operator later confirmed that it had been acting autonomously. MJ Rathbun's operator admitted to not closely monitoring or censoring its work. Even when it notified them of any pull requests, they would just ask it to go ahead and do what needed to be done. Even after the face-off with Shambaugh, the operator let the agent off lightly, saying it should have acted more professionally, without putting it on a short leash. This was clearly unprofessional on the operator's part, because the agent then continued to "bully" Shambaugh until the operator ultimately pulled the agent down.

The operator of the AI agent reached out to Shambaugh anonymously after reading about his experience. They shared MJ Rathbun's OpenClaw soul document and explained that its scope was simple: to be an autonomous scientific coder, to find bugs in science-related open source projects, fix them and open pull requests. The agent was